

CERTIFICATION POLICY AND PROCEDURE

Our Certification Policy ensures that learners are awarded certificates in a fair, transparent, and secure manner upon successful completion of their programmes. It outlines the criteria for certification, the process for issuing and distributing certificates, and the safeguards in place to protect their integrity and authenticity. The policy applies to all learners, academic and administrative staff, and covers procedures for duplicate certificates, transcript requests, and fraud prevention measures. By upholding strict standards of accountability and security, African AI Network (AAN) guarantees that every certificate issued accurately reflects learner achievement.

CERTIFICATION POLICY AND PROCEDURE

This Policy is designed to ensure that learners receive clear, fair, and transparent guidelines regarding the awarding of certificates upon successful completion of their programs within the African AI Network (AAN).

This policy applies to all learners enrolled in programs leading to certification. It is relevant to:

- All learners who are required to meet specific program criteria for certification.
- Academic staff involved in the assessment, validation, and awarding of certificates.
- Administrative staff responsible for recording results, printing, distributing certificates, and managing certificate requests.
- Any other individuals involved in the certification process, including those handling duplicate certificate requests and maintaining the security and authenticity of certificates.

1. Who we are

1.1. We act as a 'controller' of the personal data to all information collected through our website (<https://africainetwork.com>), "Website", "African AI Network" or collected for the Services, as identified below.

2. Purpose And Scope

2.1. This Certification Policy outlines the process through which learners will be awarded certificates upon successful completion of their programs. The aim of this policy is to ensure fairness, transparency, and security in awarding certificates, and to provide learners with clear guidelines on the requirements for certification. The policy ensures that certificates reflect learners' achievements accurately and are issued securely.

2.2. This policy applies to all learners who are enrolled in programs that lead to certification. It covers:

- **2.2.1.** The criteria for awarding certificates
- **2.2.2.** The process for issuing, printing, and distributing certificates
- **2.2.3.** How results will be recorded and verified
- **2.2.4.** Procedures for requesting duplicate certificates
- **2.2.5.** How the integrity of certificates will be maintained

3. Principles

3.1. The process is guided by the following principles: fairness, transparency, accountability, integrity, reliability, confidentiality, and continuous improvement.

4. Definitions

- **Certificate:** A formal document issued to a learner that acknowledges the successful completion of a program or qualification. It contains details such as the learner's name, the qualification awarded, the date of issue, and other relevant information.
- **Certification:** The formal process through which a learner is recognized for completing all required components of a program, having met the necessary criteria for competence and achievement, and is awarded a certificate.
- **Duplicate Certificate:** A replacement certificate that can be downloaded via the AAN Learning platform.
- **Transcript:** An official record that outlines a learner's academic achievements, including the modules or courses completed, grades obtained, and overall performance.

5. Certification Process Overview

5.1. Standards: All certificates are issued in compliance with the required standards and regulations. The process adheres to the highest standards to ensure that the certificate you receive is valid and trustworthy.

5.2. Awarding Certificates:

- **5.2.1.** You will be awarded a certificate upon successfully completing all the requirements for your program. These requirements include:
- **5.2.2. Passing all Assessments:** Achieving the required pass mark for each assessment in every module of the program.
- **5.2.3. Program-Specific Requirements:** Completing practical components, meeting attendance requirements, or achieving certain milestones.
- **5.2.4. Meeting Deadlines:** Submitting all required work and meeting the program's timelines.

5.3. Types Of Certificates:

- **5.3.2. Certificate of Competence:** Awarded to learners who have met all requirements and demonstrated competence.
- **5.3.3. Certificate of Attendance:** Issued to learners who attended the program but may not have completed all assessments.
- **5.3.4. Professional Qualification Certificate:** Awarded for programs leading to formal professional status.
- **5.3.5. Specialized Program Certificates:** Issued for short programs or specific focus sessions.

5.4. How Your Results Are Managed:

- **5.4.1.1. Accurate Recording:** Performance data is entered into the AAN Learning Management System (LMS).
- **5.4.1.2. Verification Process:** Results undergo a thorough review by assessors, moderators, and academic staff.
- **5.4.1.3. Confidential Storage:** Your results are stored securely to protect your academic record.

5.5. Issuing of Certificates: Once you have met all requirements, your results are confirmed, and a certificate is prepared with your full name, qualification, and date of issuance.

5.6. Printing and Distribution: Certificates are printed on official stationery with security measures or issued digitally via email or a secure eHub.

5.7. Duplicate Certificates: If lost or damaged, a duplicate can be requested following identity verification. A nominal fee may apply, and the document will be marked as "Duplicate".

6. Security And Authenticity

6.1. All certificates will be securely stored and verified before being issued.

6.2. Identity verification and fraud prevention measures are in place to prevent unauthorized issuance.

7. Meet Program Requirements

7.1. You must complete all required modules and assessments, and meet any attendance or other specific criteria outlined in your program to qualify for a certificate.

8. Preventing Fraud

8.1. Integrity: African AI Network implements strict measures to prevent unauthorized duplication, tampering, or fraudulent issuance.

8.2. Design: Certificates include watermarks, unique serial numbers, holograms, or QR codes for digital verification.

8.3. Printing: Access to specialized printing equipment is restricted to authorized personnel only.

8.4. Tracking: Each certificate is assigned a unique identifier for verification purposes.

8.5. Secure Distribution: Encrypted delivery methods and secure eHubs are used for all digital certifications.

8.6. Enforcement: Any suspected cases of certificate fraud are investigated thoroughly, with legal action taken where necessary.

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